Career Ka Dost

Ask before you decide

Class 10 English

5 Sample Papers

Board Exam 2027 | CBSE 2026-27 syllabus | Latest 3-section paper pattern

5 full-length practice papers of 80 marks each (3 hours, 11 questions): Reading, Grammar and Writing, and Literature.

Paper	Difficulty
Paper 1	Easy
Paper 2	Moderate to Hard
Paper 3	Moderate to Hard
Paper 4	Moderate to Hard
Paper 5	Hard

Sample Paper 1

CLASS 10 | ENGLISH (LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE)

Board Examination Practice Paper (2026-27 pattern) | Level: Easy

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: 3 Hours

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains **11** questions. **All questions are compulsory.**
2. The paper has **three sections**: Section A - Reading Skills (20 marks), Section B - Grammar and Creative Writing Skills (20 marks) and Section C - Literature (40 marks).
3. **Section A:** Q1 and Q2 are passage-based questions (10 marks each). Read the passages carefully and answer the questions that follow.
4. **Section B:** Q3 is a grammar question: attempt **any ten** of the twelve tasks (1 mark each). Q4 is a formal letter and Q5 is an analytical paragraph (5 marks each, about 120 words, with internal choice).
5. **Section C:** Q6 and Q7 are extract-based questions (5 marks each, internal choice). Q8: attempt any four of five questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q9: attempt any two of three questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q10 and Q11: attempt any one of the two given (6 marks each, 100-120 words).
6. In Q6 and Q7, a short passage or the name of the poem with the lines to be read is given. For poems, read the lines named from your textbook before answering.
7. All the details given in the writing tasks are imaginary and have been created for practice only.
8. Marks for each question are shown in square brackets on the right.

SECTION A - READING SKILLS (20 Marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) Millets are a group of small-seeded grasses that people have grown for thousands of years. In India, they were a part of the daily diet long before rice and wheat became common on every plate. Jowar, bajra and ragi are the best-known millets, and they are often called 'nutri-cereals' because they are packed with nutrients.

(2) Unlike many other crops, millets do not need much water or fertiliser. They grow well in poor soil and survive in dry regions where rice would wither. A farmer in a drought-prone area can therefore depend on millets even when the rains are weak. This is why they are sometimes described as 'climate-smart' crops.

(3) Millets are also good for health. Ragi is rich in calcium and helps build strong bones, while bajra gives plenty of iron. Because millets have a lot of fibre, they release energy slowly and keep a person feeling full for a longer time. Doctors often advise people with diabetes to include them in their meals.

(4) In the decades after independence, the country focused on growing more rice and wheat to feed its growing population. Millets slowly disappeared from kitchens, and many young people had never even tasted them. Farmers, too, shifted to crops that the government bought at fixed prices.

(5) Things have begun to change. The United Nations declared 2023 the International Year of Millets, following a proposal made by India. Since then, restaurants, school canteens and food companies have introduced millet cookies, noodles and breakfast bowls. State governments are encouraging farmers to grow millets by providing seeds and better prices.

(6) Experts, however, warn that a revival cannot succeed by advertising alone. Many consumers still find millets difficult to cook, and processing them into flour takes time. Cooking classes, simple recipes and low-cost machines could help households take them up again.

(7) If these steps are taken, millets may soon return from the margins of the kitchen to the centre of the plate. Our grandparents ate them with joy; perhaps it is time we did the same.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) Why are jowar, bajra and ragi called 'nutri-cereals'? *(Paragraph 1)* **[1]**

(A) They are grown only by rich farmers. **(B)** They are packed with nutrients.
(C) They are eaten only in winter. **(D)** They are cheaper than rice and wheat.

(ii) Complete the sentence appropriately. **[1]**
Millets are called 'climate-smart' crops because _____. *(Paragraph 2)*

(iii) List any two health benefits of millets mentioned in the passage. *(Paragraph 3)* **[2]**

(iv) State whether the following statement is True or False. **[1]**
Doctors usually advise people with diabetes to avoid millets. *(Paragraph 3)*

(v) Which of the following is the reason why farmers shifted away from millets? *(Paragraph 4)* **[1]**

(A) Millets need a lot of water.
(B) Farmers grew crops that the government bought at fixed prices.
(C) Millets are harmful for children.
(D) Farmers did not have any land.

(vi) The phrase 'the margins of the kitchen' in paragraph 7 suggests that millets were _____. **[1]**

(A) the main food in every home **(B)** used only for festivals
(C) pushed to the edge and rarely cooked **(D)** banned by the government

(vii) What steps does the writer suggest to bring millets back into our homes? Answer in about 40 words. *(Paragraphs 5 and 6)* **[2]**

(viii) Pick a word from paragraph 5 that means the same as 'supporting'. **[1]**

2. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) Many Indian cities face a shortage of water every summer. As cities grow, more concrete roads and buildings cover the ground, and rainwater runs off into drains instead of soaking into the soil. The groundwater level therefore keeps falling.

(2) Rainwater harvesting offers a simple answer. Rain that falls on roofs is guided through pipes into tanks or into pits that recharge the ground. A small household can store thousands of litres in a single monsoon. The stored water can be used for washing, gardening and cleaning, which reduces the demand for tap water.

(3) Several cities have made harvesting compulsory for new buildings above a certain size. The residents of Green Park Society installed such a system in 2019. The table below shows how the society's dependence on tanker water changed.

Water use in Green Park Society (in thousand litres)

Year	Rainwater stored	Tanker water bought
2019	120	900
2020	310	760
2021	480	590
2022	640	420
2023	700	310

Experts say that harvesting works best when everyone takes part. A single society cannot solve the water problem of a whole city, but many societies together can help the water table to rise again.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) Why does rainwater run off in cities instead of soaking into the soil? *(Paragraph 1)* **[1]**

(A) Because it rains very little
(B) Because concrete roads and buildings cover the ground
(C) Because there are too many trees
(D) Because drains are always closed

(ii) Complete the sentence. **[1]**
Rain that falls on roofs is guided through pipes into tanks or into _____.
(Paragraph 2)

(iii) State whether the following statement is True or False. **[1]**
The stored rainwater is used mainly for drinking. *(Paragraph 2)*

(iv) In which year did the society buy the least amount of tanker water? **[1]**

(A) 2019 **(B)** 2021
(C) 2022 **(D)** 2023

(v) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
Harvesting rainwater (increases / reduces) the demand for tap water.

(vi) By how many thousand litres did the purchase of tanker water fall between 2019 and 2023? **[1]**

(vii) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. **[1]**
Assertion: Many Indian cities face a fall in the groundwater level.
Reason: Roads and buildings stop rainwater from soaking into the ground.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(viii) Which words in the last paragraph tell us that harvesting needs everyone's participation? **[1]**

(ix) In about 40 words, explain how rainwater harvesting can help a city that faces a water shortage. *(Paragraphs 2 and 4)* **[2]**

SECTION B – GRAMMAR AND CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (20 Marks)

GRAMMAR

3. Complete **any ten** of the following twelve tasks, as directed. **[10 x 1 = 10]**

(i) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in brackets, for the given portion of a letter. **[1]**
'Thank you for _____ (send) me the brochure so quickly.'

(ii) Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. Use the format given below. **[1]**
Each of the students have submitted the project on time.

Error	Correction

(iii) Meera asked her teacher, "Will you explain this sum once more ?" **[1]**
Report Meera's question.

(iv) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete a notice. **[1]**
Admissions to the summer camp _____ open till 30 April.

(A) is **(B)** are
(C) has **(D)** was

(v) Read the dialogue between a father and his son. **[1]**
Father: Have you packed your bag ?
Son: Yes, I packed it last night.
Select the correct option to complete the report.
The father asked his son _____. The son replied that he had packed it the night before.

(A) if he has packed his bag **(B)** if he had packed his bag
(C) if he packs his bag **(D)** that he had packed his bag

(vi) Complete the sentence by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
Our school team _____ the inter-school quiz last year.

(A) win **(B)** wins
(C) won **(D)** winning

(vii) Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. Use the format given below. **[1]**
She is the taller girl in our class.

Error	Correction

(viii) Report the teacher's instruction. **[1]**
Teacher to the students: "Submit your notebooks tomorrow."
The teacher told the students _____.

(ix) Fill in the blank with the correct option. **[1]**
There is _____ water left in the bottle, so we must refill it.

(A) a few **(B)** few
(C) little **(D)** many

(x) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the given sentence. **[1]**
He gave me an useful suggestion.

Option	Error	Correction
(A)	an	a
(B)	gave	give
(C)	me	I
(D)	suggestion	suggestions

(xi) Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the sentence from a road-safety poster. **[1]**
You _____ wear a seat belt while driving; it is the law.

(A) might **(B)** must
(C) can **(D)** may

(xii) Read the conversation between Rohan and the doctor. **[1]**
Rohan: I am feeling feverish.
Doctor: You should take rest for two days.
Complete the report.
Rohan told the doctor that _____. The doctor advised him _____.

CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for practice purpose.

4. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

(A) You are Aman / Amrita, a resident of Rose Apartments, Sector 14, Gurugram. The garbage in your colony has not been collected regularly for the past two weeks. Heaps of waste have piled up near the park, spreading a foul smell and the fear of disease. Write a letter, in about 120 words, to the Municipal Commissioner complaining about the problem and requesting urgent action.

OR

(B) Plastic carry bags are still being freely used in your local market in spite of the ban. You are Tara / Tarun, a student of Class 10. Write a letter to the editor of a local daily, in about 120 words, expressing your concern and suggesting ways to reduce the use of plastic.

5. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

(A) The table below shows how the students of Class 10 in a school travel to school. Write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the information given. Make comparisons and draw conclusions wherever possible.

Mode of travel to school (percentage of students)

Mode of travel	Boys (%)	Girls (%)
Walking	20	16
Cycle	28	15
School bus	30	42
Public transport	14	16
Private vehicle	8	11

OR

(B) Read the following details about the benefits of regular reading.
- improves vocabulary and imagination
- reduces stress and builds concentration
- develops empathy for others
- costs very little; books are available in libraries

Analyse the details and write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the importance of developing a reading habit.

Career Ka Dost Ask before you decide

SECTION C – LITERATURE (40 Marks)

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Read the following passage based on the lesson 'A Letter to God' and answer the questions that follow.

> After the hailstorm had flattened his field of ripe corn, Lencho sat down and wrote to the only one he trusted completely. He asked God to send him a hundred pesos so that he could sow his field again and feed his family until the next harvest. On the envelope he wrote 'To God'. The postmaster read the address with amusement, but soon grew serious. He admired the farmer's unshakable faith and decided to answer the letter himself.

(i) Why did Lencho write the letter? **[1]**

(A) to complain about the hailstorm **(B)** to ask for money to sow the field again

(C) to thank God for the harvest **(D)** to invite the postmaster to his farm

(ii) The postmaster 'read the address with amusement, but soon grew serious'. Why did his reaction change? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
Lencho's act of writing to God shows his _____ (faith / doubt).

(iv) What does the phrase 'unshakable faith' tell us about Lencho? **[1]**

OR

(B) Read the following passage based on the lesson 'From the Diary of Anne Frank' and answer the questions that follow.

> Anne Frank was a thirteen-year-old girl who had loving parents, an elder sister and a large circle of friends. On the surface she seemed to have everything, yet she felt lonely. With her friends she could only talk about ordinary, everyday matters, and she longed for someone to whom she could open her heart. So she decided to treat her diary as a close friend and gave it the name 'Kitty'.

(i) Why did Anne Frank begin to write in her diary? **[1]**

(A) She had no family.
(B) She wanted to become a famous writer.
(C) She longed for a true friend to confide in.
(D) Her teacher had asked her to.

(ii) Anne 'seemed to have everything, yet she felt lonely'. How can we infer this from the passage? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with one word. **[1]**
Anne gave her diary the name _____.

(iv) Anne's friends talked only about 'ordinary, everyday matters'. What does this tell us about her friendships? **[1]**

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Refer to the poem 'Dust of Snow' by Robert Frost (First Flight). Read the lines carefully in your textbook before answering. In the poem a crow shakes down a little snow from a hemlock tree on the speaker, and the speaker's mood changes.

(i) The crow and the hemlock tree are traditionally seen as signs of **[1]**

_____.

(A) joy **(B)** sorrow
(C) wealth **(D)** friendship

(ii) How does a small incident change the speaker's mood? Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
At the end of the poem the speaker's mood can be described as _____ (gloomy / cheerful).

(iv) What does the poet mean by 'a part of a day I had rued'? **[1]**

OR

(B) Refer to the first two stanzas of the poem 'A Tiger in the Zoo' by Leonard Clark (First Flight), beginning 'He stalks in his vivid stripes'. Read the lines carefully in your textbook before answering.

(i) Identify the figure of speech in the phrase 'pads of velvet'. **[1]**

(A) simile **(B)** metaphor
(C) hyperbole **(D)** alliteration

(ii) What, according to the poet, should the tiger be doing in his natural surroundings instead of pacing in the cage? Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
The words 'quiet rage' show that the tiger is _____ (content / frustrated).

(iv) State whether the following statement is True or False. **[1]**
The tiger in the zoo has a lot of space to move about.

8. Answer **any four** of the following five questions in about 40-50 words each. **[4 x 3 = 12]**

(i) What did Mandela say about courage in his speech? How, according to him, does a brave man deal with fear? *(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)*

(ii) Where is Coorg located? Mention two things that make the region special. *(Glimpses of India)*

(iii) How did Custard behave when the pirate came to the house, and how did the others react afterwards? *(The Tale of Custard the Dragon)*

(iv) What lesson does the little boy learn when he loses his ball? *(The Ball Poem)*

(v) How did Mijbil's love for water show itself in the author's flat in London? *(Mijbil the Otter)*

9. Answer **any two** of the following three questions in about 40-50 words each. **[2 x 3 = 6]**

(i) How did Hari Singh come to work for Anil, and what did he plan to do? *(The Thief's Story)*

(ii) Why was Tricki Woo unwell? What did Mr Herriot suggest as the treatment? *(A Triumph of Surgery)*

(iii) How did Ausable save himself from Max? Answer in about 40 words. *(The Midnight Visitor)*

10. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) What did Valli's bus ride teach her about herself and about the world around her? Answer in about 100–120 words. *(Madam Rides the Bus)*

OR

(B) Through the story of Kisa Gotami, what lesson did the Buddha want to teach? How did he help her to understand it? Answer in about 100–120 words. *(The Sermon at Benares)*

11. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) Education changed Bholi's life completely. Describe the transformation in her character. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(Bholi)*

OR

(B) What lesson does 'The Necklace' teach us? Do you think Mathilde was responsible for her own misfortune? Give reasons. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(The Necklace)*

- End of Question Paper -

Career Ka Dost
Ask before you decide

Sample Paper 2

CLASS 10 | ENGLISH (LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE)

Board Examination Practice Paper (2026-27 pattern) | Level: Moderate to Hard

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: 3 Hours

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains **11** questions. **All questions are compulsory.**
2. The paper has **three sections**: Section A - Reading Skills (20 marks), Section B - Grammar and Creative Writing Skills (20 marks) and Section C - Literature (40 marks).
3. **Section A:** Q1 and Q2 are passage-based questions (10 marks each). Read the passages carefully and answer the questions that follow.
4. **Section B:** Q3 is a grammar question: attempt **any ten** of the twelve tasks (1 mark each). Q4 is a formal letter and Q5 is an analytical paragraph (5 marks each, about 120 words, with internal choice).
5. **Section C:** Q6 and Q7 are extract-based questions (5 marks each, internal choice). Q8: attempt any four of five questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q9: attempt any two of three questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q10 and Q11: attempt any one of the two given (6 marks each, 100-120 words).
6. In Q6 and Q7, a short passage or the name of the poem with the lines to be read is given. For poems, read the lines named from your textbook before answering.
7. All the details given in the writing tasks are imaginary and have been created for practice only.
8. Marks for each question are shown in square brackets on the right.

SECTION A - READING SKILLS (20 Marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) The sound of a petrol engine has been the background music of city life for more than a century. Today, that music is slowly fading. Electric vehicles (EVs), which run on batteries instead of fuel, are appearing on roads, in showrooms and in government policy documents. Whether they are a passing fashion or the future of transport is a question being debated in homes and boardrooms alike.

(2) The most obvious advantage of an EV is that it releases no smoke from an exhaust pipe. In crowded cities, where vehicles are a major source of air pollution, this could mean cleaner air and fewer breathing problems. An electric motor is also quieter and has far fewer moving parts than a petrol engine, so it is cheaper to maintain. Over several years, the money saved on fuel and repairs can make up for the higher price paid at the showroom.

(3) However, the picture is not entirely green. An EV is only as clean as the electricity that charges it; if that power comes from coal, the pollution has merely shifted from the road to the power plant. Batteries, too, are made from minerals such as lithium and cobalt, whose mining damages the land and uses a great deal of water. When batteries wear out after eight to ten years, disposing of them safely is a challenge that the world has not yet fully solved.

(4) Charging is another concern. A driver can fill a petrol tank in three minutes, but charging a battery may take an hour or more, and charging stations are still few in number outside large cities. This fear of being stranded with an empty battery, known as 'range anxiety', stops many buyers from making the switch.

(5) Governments have responded with incentives. Several states in India have reduced taxes on EVs, offered subsidies to buyers and promised to build thousands of public charging points. Two-wheelers and three-wheelers have led the change because they are cheaper, need smaller batteries and are used mostly for short trips. Electric buses are also being introduced in many cities.

(6) Experts believe that the real revolution will come when three things happen together: batteries become cheaper and last longer, electricity is produced mainly from renewable sources, and charging becomes as convenient as refuelling. Until then, EVs are best seen not as a magic cure but as an important step in the right direction.

(7) The road ahead may be quiet, but the debate surrounding it is certainly not. A wise citizen will weigh both sides of the argument before deciding which vehicle to drive — or whether to drive at all.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) What is the tone of the writer in the given lines? Rationalise your response in about 40 words. **[2]**
"The sound of a petrol engine has been the background music of city life for more than a century. Today, that music is slowly fading." *(Paragraph 1)*

(ii) Which of the following best explains the sentence 'the picture is not entirely green'? *(Paragraph 3)* **[1]**

(A) EVs are painted green in colour.
(B) EVs have some environmental drawbacks as well.
(C) EVs can run only on green energy.
(D) EVs are not popular in rural areas.

(iii) Complete the sentence with a suitable phrase from paragraph 3. **[1]**
An EV is only as clean as _____.

(iv) 'Range anxiety' in paragraph 4 refers to _____. **[1]**

(A) the fear that the battery may run out before reaching a charging point
(B) the worry about the high price of the vehicle
(C) the stress of driving in heavy traffic
(D) the fear of accidents on highways

(v) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. **[1]**
Assertion: Two-wheelers and three-wheelers have led the shift towards EVs in India.
Reason: They are cheaper, need smaller batteries and are used mostly for short trips.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(vi) Based on paragraphs 2 and 3, state one advantage and one disadvantage of electric vehicles. **[2]**

(vii) In sets (a) to (e) below, identify the two sets of synonyms. **[1]**
(a) fading – declining (b) incentives – penalties (c) cheaper – costlier
(d) challenge – difficulty (e) stranded – rescued

(A) (a) and (b) **(B)** (a) and (d)
(C) (b) and (c) **(D)** (c) and (e)

(viii) Which of the following best reflects the writer's overall view of electric vehicles? **[1]**

(A) They are a perfect solution to all pollution.
(B) They are harmful and should be banned.
(C) They are a useful step forward but not a complete cure.
(D) They are a passing fashion that will soon disappear.

2. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) A survey of 1,200 students of Classes 8 to 10 in six cities was conducted to find out how the reading habits of teenagers change as they grow older. The students were asked how many books they had read for pleasure, apart from their textbooks, during the previous year. The results are shown in the table below.

Books read for pleasure in one year (percentage of students)

Class	No book	1 to 3 books	4 or more books
Class 8	18	42	40
Class 9	27	45	28
Class 10	39	42	19

The students who read very little blamed a lack of time because of homework and coaching classes, the pull of phones and short videos, and a feeling that reading is 'boring'. Those who read regularly said that there was a small library at home or in school and that at least one parent was a reader. Researchers therefore recommended a weekly reading period in the school timetable, well-stocked class libraries and a 'family reading hour' at home.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) The survey was conducted to find out _____. **[1]**

(A) how many textbooks students own
(B) how reading habits change as teenagers grow older
(C) which books teenagers like most
(D) how much time students spend on phones

(ii) According to the table, which class has the highest percentage of students who read four or more books? **[1]**

(iii) By how many percentage points did the share of students who read no book rise from Class 8 to Class 10? **[1]**

(iv) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. **[1]**
Assertion: Students who read regularly are likely to come from homes or schools that have books.
Reason: Researchers found that regular readers usually had a small library nearby and a parent who read.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(v) Complete the sentence. **[1]**
Researchers suggested a weekly reading period in the school timetable and a '_____' at home.

(vi) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
The data show that reading for pleasure (declines / increases) as students move to higher classes.

(vii) Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a reason for the decline in reading? **[1]**

(A) Lack of time
(B) The attraction of phones and short videos
(C) The belief that reading is boring
(D) The high price of books

(viii) Justify the statement: 'Reading habits are shaped by the environment at home and at school.' **[1]**

(ix) In about 40 words, suggest how a school can encourage its students to read more, using the information given in the passage. **[2]**

SECTION B – GRAMMAR AND CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (20 Marks)

GRAMMAR

3. Complete **any ten** of the following twelve tasks, as directed. **[10 x 1 = 10]**

(i) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in brackets, for the given portion of a letter. **[1]**
'I am writing to inform you that the examination _____ (schedule) for Monday has been postponed.'

(ii) Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. Use the format given below. **[1]**
Neither of the answers are correct.

Error	Correction

(iii) Ravi asked his sister, "Where did you keep my keys ?" **[1]**
Report Ravi's question.

(iv) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
I have been learning the guitar _____ last June.
(A) for **(B)** since
(C) from **(D)** during

(v) Read the dialogue between a teacher and a student. **[1]**
Teacher: Why are you late today ?
Student: The bus broke down on the way.
Select the correct option to complete the report.
The teacher asked the student _____. The student replied that the bus had broken down on the way.
(A) why was he late that day **(B)** why he was late that day
(C) why is he late today **(D)** that why he was late that day

(vi) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the given sentence. **[1]**
She suggested to go for a walk after dinner.

Option	Error	Correction
(A)	suggested	suggests
(B)	to go	going
(C)	for	to
(D)	after	before

(vii) Report the mother's request. **[1]**
Mother to Rani: "Please don't leave the gate open."
The mother requested Rani _____.

(viii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
If I _____ you, I would apologise to him at once.

(A) am **(B)** was
(C) were **(D)** be

(ix) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the line from a school notice. **[1]**
A number of students _____ absent from school today.

(A) is **(B)** are
(C) was **(D)** has been

(x) Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. Use the format given below. **[1]**
Hardly had we reached the station when the train leaves.

Error	Correction

(xi) Read the conversation between two friends. **[1]**
Neha: I have never seen such a beautiful sunset.
Her friend: Neither have I.
Complete the report.
Neha told her friend that _____.

(xii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the news item. **[1]**
The workers have called _____ the strike after the talks succeeded.

(A) off **(B)** out
(C) up **(D)** in

CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for practice purpose.

4. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

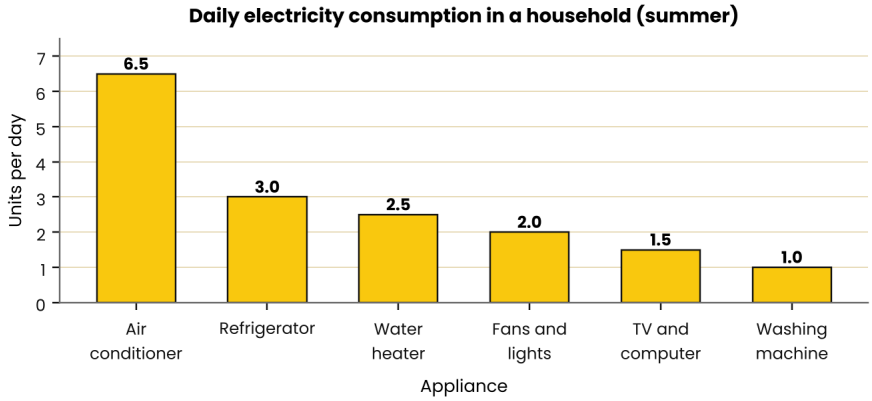
(A) You are Karan / Kritika, a student of Class 10 in Delhi. You wish to join a three-week spoken English course after your board examinations. Write a letter, in about 120 words, to the Director, Speak Well Academy, Karol Bagh, enquiring about the course content, duration, fees, batch timings and the certificate offered.

OR

(B) You are Mehul / Meghna, the librarian of Greenfield Public School. You have received the price list and the reply to your earlier enquiry from Bookworld Publishers, Daryaganj. You find the terms satisfactory. Write a letter, in about 120 words, placing an order for 60 reference books. Refer to your previous letter and mention the quantity, the discount expected, the mode of payment and the date of delivery.

5. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

(A) The bar graph below shows the average daily consumption of electricity (in units) by different appliances in a household in summer. Write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the information given. Make comparisons and draw conclusions wherever possible.



OR

(B) Read the following details about the effects of noise pollution.
- causes stress, headaches and poor sleep
- reduces the concentration of students
- harms the hearing of people living near busy roads
- sources: traffic, loudspeakers, construction, fireworks
- remedies: horn-free zones, rules on loudspeakers, public awareness

Analyse the details and write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the causes, effects and control of noise pollution.

SECTION C – LITERATURE (40 Marks)

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Read the following passage based on the lesson 'Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom' and answer the questions that follow.

> On the day he was sworn in as President, Mandela felt that he was standing at the meeting point of a long history. He thought of how, at the start of the century, the white rulers of South Africa had put in place a racial order that treated the black majority as inferior, an order that he describes as one of the cruellest societies the world had ever known. Ninety years later, in his old age, that order was gone, and a new system in which every person had equal rights had taken its place.

(i) The 'racial order' that Mandela mentions was one in which _____. **[1]**

(A) all people were treated equally **(B)** the black majority was treated as inferior

(C) the white people were treated unfairly **(D)** no one had the right to vote

(ii) Why was the day of the inauguration so significant for Mandela? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
The new system treats every person _____ (equally / differently).

(iv) Pick a phrase from the passage that shows Mandela's opinion of the old racial order. **[1]**

OR

(B) Read the following passage based on the lesson 'The Thief's Story' and answer the questions that follow.

> Hari Singh, a young thief, took up a job as a servant with Anil, a writer who lived alone, because he planned to rob him. Anil never seemed to suspect the boy. He taught Hari Singh to cook and to write his own name, and promised to teach him to write whole sentences and to add numbers. Hari Singh felt grateful. He also suspected that Anil knew about the little profit he made on the day's shopping, but Anil never objected.

(i) What did Anil promise to teach Hari Singh in addition to cooking and writing his name? **[1]**

(A) to drive a car
(B) to write whole sentences and to add numbers
(C) to repair locks
(D) to sell things in the market

(ii) Anil knew that Hari Singh made a little profit on the day's shopping but did not object. What does this show about Anil's character? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
Hari Singh felt _____ (grateful / angry) when Anil offered to teach him.

(iv) Why had Hari Singh taken up the job with Anil? **[1]**

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Refer to the last stanza of the poem 'How to Tell Wild Animals' by Carolyn Wells (First Flight), beginning 'Though to distinguish beasts of prey'. Read the lines carefully in your textbook before answering.

(i) According to the stanza, a crocodile can be told apart from a hyena by its _____. **[1]**

(A) roar **(B)** tears
(C) colour **(D)** tail

(ii) Explain the irony in the last two lines of the stanza. Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with one word. **[1]**
The word 'novice' refers to a _____ person.

(iv) Which of the following best describes the mood created by the stanza? **[1]**

(A) serious and gloomy **(B)** light and humorous
(C) fearful and tense **(D)** sad and thoughtful

OR

(B) Refer to the poem 'Fire and Ice' by Robert Frost (First Flight). Read the poem carefully in your textbook before answering.

(i) In the poem, 'fire' stands for _____. **[1]**

(A) hatred **(B)** desire
(C) fear **(D)** anger

(ii) Why does the poet say that ice would also be enough to destroy the world? Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Complete the sentence. **[1]**
The poet suggests that the human emotions of _____ and _____ can be equally destructive.

(iv) Select the option that gives the correct rhyme scheme of the poem. **[1]**

(A) abaabcbcb **(B)** ababcdcdc
(C) aabbccdde **(D)** abcabcabc

8. Answer **any four** of the following five questions in about 40-50 words each. **[4 x 3 = 12]**

(i) What did Lencho write about the post-office employees in his second letter? Why did he write so? *(A Letter to God)*

(ii) Why does Anne Frank say that 'paper has more patience than people'? Explain in your own words. *(From the Diary of Anne Frank)*

(iii) What did Valli have to do before she could take her bus ride? What does it show about her? *(Madam Rides the Bus)*

(iv) What does Amanda dream of becoming? What do her dreams tell us about her? *(Amanda!)*

(v) What is the central idea of the poem 'Fog'? How does the poet describe the way the fog arrives? *(Fog)*

9. Answer **any two** of the following three questions in about 40-50 words each. **[2 x 3 = 6]**

(i) What did Madame Forestier tell Mathilde when she met her after ten years? Why was this news a shock? *(The Necklace)*

(ii) Why was Bholi considered unattractive and unintelligent by her family? *(Bholi)*

(iii) How did Richard Ebright come to be involved with Dr Urquhart's project? What did this lead to? *(The Making of a Scientist)*

10. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) Amanda in the poem and Valli in 'Madam Rides the Bus' are both young girls who long for freedom. Compare their situations and the ways in which they seek it. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(Amanda! and Madam Rides the Bus)*

OR

(B) 'The Proposal' is a comedy built on quarrels. Describe the issues over which Lomov and Natalya argue and explain how the playwright creates humour through them. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(The Proposal)*

11. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) Horace Danby trusted the lady in red and paid for it. Do you think the title 'A Question of Trust' is suitable for the story? Give reasons. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(A Question of Trust)*

OR

(B) Griffin's great scientific discovery became a burden for him. Explain how, with reference to the lesson. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(Footprints Without Feet)*

- End of Question Paper -

Sample Paper 3

CLASS 10 | ENGLISH (LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE)

Board Examination Practice Paper (2026-27 pattern) | Level: Moderate to Hard

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: 3 Hours

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains **11** questions. **All questions are compulsory.**
2. The paper has **three sections**: Section A - Reading Skills (20 marks), Section B - Grammar and Creative Writing Skills (20 marks) and Section C - Literature (40 marks).
3. **Section A:** Q1 and Q2 are passage-based questions (10 marks each). Read the passages carefully and answer the questions that follow.
4. **Section B:** Q3 is a grammar question: attempt **any ten** of the twelve tasks (1 mark each). Q4 is a formal letter and Q5 is an analytical paragraph (5 marks each, about 120 words, with internal choice).
5. **Section C:** Q6 and Q7 are extract-based questions (5 marks each, internal choice). Q8: attempt any four of five questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q9: attempt any two of three questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q10 and Q11: attempt any one of the two given (6 marks each, 100-120 words).
6. In Q6 and Q7, a short passage or the name of the poem with the lines to be read is given. For poems, read the lines named from your textbook before answering.
7. All the details given in the writing tasks are imaginary and have been created for practice only.
8. Marks for each question are shown in square brackets on the right.

SECTION A – READING SKILLS (20 Marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) Along the muddy edges of India's coasts grows a unique forest that stands with its roots in salt water. These are the mangroves, a group of trees and shrubs that thrive where rivers meet the sea. The Sundarbans in West Bengal, shared with Bangladesh, is the largest mangrove forest in the world and is the home of the Royal Bengal tiger.

(2) Mangroves have developed remarkable ways of surviving in salty water. Many have stilt-like roots that rise out of the mud and hold the tree firm against the tides, while others send up pencil-shaped roots that breathe air above the water. Some species can even push out salt through their leaves. These adaptations make mangroves one of the toughest forests on earth.

(3) For the people of the coast, mangroves are a natural shield. When cyclones and tsunamis strike, the dense tangle of roots slows down the waves and reduces the force of the wind. After the super cyclone of 1999 in Odisha, villages protected by mangroves are reported to have suffered far less damage than those without them. The roots also trap silt, which keeps the shore from being eaten away by the sea.

(4) Mangroves are also the nurseries of the ocean. Fish, prawns and crabs lay their eggs in the shelter of the roots, and the young ones grow up safe from larger predators. Millions of fishermen depend on this catch for their livelihood. In addition, mangroves absorb large amounts of carbon dioxide and store it in their soil for centuries, which helps to slow down climate change.

(5) Despite their value, mangroves are disappearing. India has lost a large part of its mangrove cover to shrimp farms, ports, hotels and the dumping of waste. Many people see the swampy land as useless and are eager to convert it into something 'profitable'.

(6) Some communities have shown a better way. In parts of Gujarat and Maharashtra, villagers have planted mangrove saplings along the shore and guarded them as fiercely as they guard their own homes. Schools have joined the effort by adopting small patches of coast. Where these efforts have taken root, birds have returned and fish catches have increased.

(7) Protecting mangroves is not an act of charity towards nature; it is an investment in our own safety and food. A forest that stands in the mud may not look beautiful, but it stands guard over us all.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) The Sundarbans is described in the passage as _____. **[1]**

(A) the oldest forest in India **(B)** the largest mangrove forest in the world
(C) a forest found only in Bangladesh **(D)** a forest without any animals

(ii) List any two ways in which mangroves have adapted to survive in salty water. *(Paragraph 2)* **[2]**

(iii) Complete the sentence appropriately. **[1]**
During a cyclone, the dense roots of mangroves _____. *(Paragraph 3)*

(iv) State whether the following statement is True or False. **[1]**
According to the passage, mangroves help to speed up climate change. *(Paragraph 4)*

(v) Why does the writer call mangroves 'the nurseries of the ocean'? *(Paragraph 4)* **[1]**

(A) Plants are grown and sold in them.
(B) Young sea animals are born and protected there.
(C) They are used as school gardens.
(D) They produce food for farmers.

(vi) Why are people eager to convert mangrove land into something 'profitable'? What does the use of quotation marks around the word 'profitable' suggest about the writer's attitude? Answer in about 40 words. *(Paragraph 5)* **[2]**

(vii) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. **[1]**
Assertion: Mangroves protect coastal villages from cyclones.
Reason: Their dense roots slow down the waves and reduce the force of the wind.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(viii) State the main message of the last paragraph in one sentence. **[1]**

2. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) India's space journey began in 1963 with the launch of a small sounding rocket from Thumba, a fishing village in Kerala. The parts of the rocket were carried to the launch site on bicycles and bullock carts. Six decades later, India is known across the world as a space power that achieves ambitious goals at a modest cost. Some important missions of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) are listed below.

Some landmark missions of ISRO

Mission	Year	Purpose
Aryabhata	1975	India's first satellite
Chandrayaan-1	2008	Orbiter to study the Moon
Mangalyaan	2014	India's first Mars mission
Chandrayaan-3	2023	Soft landing near the Moon's south pole
Aditya-L1	2023	Observation of the Sun

The Mars mission was completed on the very first attempt and is reported to have cost only about ₹450 crore, far less than many similar missions elsewhere. Space technology also touches everyday life: it gives us weather forecasts, cyclone warnings, television and mobile communication, maps for farmers and help in managing disasters. Today, private companies and student teams are also building rockets and small satellites, and many young Indians see space science as an exciting career.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) From where was India's first sounding rocket launched? **[1]**

(A) Sriharikota **(B)** Thumba
(C) Bengaluru **(D)** Chennai

(ii) According to the table, how many years passed between India's first satellite and its first Mars mission? **[1]**

(iii) Which mission was designed to observe the Sun? **[1]**

(A) Chandrayaan-1 **(B)** Mangalyaan
(C) Chandrayaan-3 **(D)** Aditya-L1

(iv) State whether the following statement is True or False. **[1]**
India's Mars mission succeeded only after several failed attempts.

(v) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
The use of bicycles and bullock carts to carry rocket parts shows that India's space programme began with _____ (limited / abundant) resources.

(vi) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. **[1]**
Assertion: India is known as a space power that achieves ambitious goals at a modest cost.
Reason: The Mars mission was completed on the first attempt at a cost of about ₹450 crore.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(vii) Complete the sentence with a suitable phrase from the passage. **[1]**
Today, private companies and student teams are building _____.

(viii) Justify the statement: 'Space science is not only about rockets; it touches our daily lives.' **[1]**

(ix) In about 40 words, explain how the table shows India's progress in space exploration over the years. **[2]**

SECTION B – GRAMMAR AND CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (20 Marks)

GRAMMAR

3. Complete **any ten** of the following twelve tasks, as directed. **[10 x 1 = 10]**

(i) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in brackets, for the given portion of a letter. **[1]**
'The doctor has advised him to avoid _____ (eat) oily food.'

(ii) Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. Use the format given below. **[1]**
The news of the victory were received with great joy.

Error	Correction

(iii) Priya asked Arjun, "Have you finished your project ?" **[1]**
Report Priya's question.

(iv) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
By the time the police arrived, the thief _____.

(A) escaped **(B)** had escaped
(C) has escaped **(D)** was escaping

(v) Read the statement made by a coach to his players. **[1]**
Coach: "The match will begin at nine."
Select the correct option to complete the report.
The coach told the players that the match _____ at nine.

(A) will begin **(B)** would begin
(C) begins **(D)** began

(vi) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the given sentence. **[1]**
The teacher, along with her students, are going on a trip.

Option	Error	Correction
(A)	along	and
(B)	are	is
(C)	going	go
(D)	trip	trips

(vii) Report the customer's request. **[1]**
Customer to the waiter: "Could you bring me the menu, please ?"
The customer requested the waiter _____.

(viii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
I have _____ interesting news for you.

(A) a **(B)** an
(C) the **(D)** some

(ix) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
Neither the teacher nor the students _____ aware of the change in the timetable.

(A) was **(B)** is
(C) were **(D)** has been

(x) Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. Use the format given below. **[1]**
She did not know how to solved the problem.

Error	Correction

(xi) Read the conversation between Sam and Tina. **[1]**
Sam: I will call you tomorrow.
Tina: Please do.
Complete the report.
Sam told Tina that _____. Tina requested him to do so.

(xii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
You _____ have told me earlier; I could have helped you.

(A) must **(B)** should
(C) would **(D)** can

CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for practice purpose.

4. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

(A) You are Reena / Rahul, the secretary of the Eco Club of Lotus Valley School. Your club recently organised a tree-plantation drive in which a hundred students took part. Write a letter, in about 120 words, to the editor of a national daily, sharing your experience, highlighting the benefits of voluntary service by teenagers and suggesting how more schools can join such activities.

OR

(B) You are Neeraj / Neelam, a resident of Shanti Enclave, Nagpur. For the past two weeks your locality has been facing frequent and long power cuts, which are disturbing the studies of students and the work of the residents. Write a letter, in about 120 words, to the Executive Engineer of the State Electricity Board, drawing his attention to the problem and requesting immediate action.

5. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

(A) The table below shows the average time (in hours) spent per day by students of three classes on different screen activities. Write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the information given. Make comparisons and draw conclusions wherever possible.

Daily screen time of students (in hours)

Activity	Class 8	Class 9	Class 10
Studying	1.5	2.0	3.0
Entertainment (videos, games)	2.0	1.5	1.0
Social media	0.5	1.0	1.5

OR

(B) Read the following details about healthy eating habits.
- eat home-cooked meals with fruits, vegetables and whole grains
- avoid too much sugar, salt and packaged snacks
- drink enough water; do not skip breakfast
- benefits: better energy, concentration and immunity
- problem: busy routines and the popularity of fast food

Analyse the details and write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the importance of healthy eating among teenagers.

SECTION C – LITERATURE (40 Marks)

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Read the following passage based on the play 'The Book That Saved the Earth' and answer the questions that follow.

> The Martians land on Earth and come across a strange object: a book. They have never seen one before and cannot decide whether it is a hat, a snack or a weapon. Think-Tank, the Martian leader who is believed to know everything, studies the object and announces, with great confidence, a conclusion that is completely wrong. His followers, Omega and Oop, accept it without a single question. The humour of the scene lies in the gap between the leader's confidence and his ignorance.

(i) The scene is humorous mainly because _____. **[1]**

(A) the Martians are afraid of the book
(B) the leader is sure of himself but is wrong
(C) the book is very large
(D) the Martians know all about Earth

(ii) Why do Omega and Oop accept Think-Tank's conclusion without question? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
Oop's idea of wearing the book on his head shows his _____ (curiosity / wisdom).

(iv) Identify the literary device used in the 'confident but wrong' conclusions of Think-Tank. **[1]**

(A) simile
(B) irony
(C) alliteration
(D) personification

OR

(B) Read the following passage based on the lesson 'Madam Rides the Bus' and answer the questions that follow.

> Valli, a girl of about eight from a small South Indian village, had longed for a long time to ride the bus that passed through her village. She saved up the fare and finally took the ride. The conductor addressed her as 'Madam', and she felt very important. She enjoyed the beauty of the countryside and clapped her hands in delight when she saw a young cow running very fast.

(i) What did Valli do in order to take the bus ride? **[1]**

(A) She borrowed money from the conductor.
(B) She saved up the fare.
(C) She sold her mother's ornaments.
(D) She won a free ticket.

(ii) The conductor called Valli 'Madam'. How did this make her feel, and what does it show about her? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with one word. **[1]**
Valli clapped her hands in _____ when she saw the young cow.

(iv) What does the word 'longed' tell us about Valli's wish to ride the bus? **[1]**

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Refer to the lines of the poem 'The Ball Poem' by John Berryman (First Flight) in which the speaker watches the boy stand helplessly after his ball has bounced into the water, and says that another ball 'is worthless'. Read the lines carefully in your textbook before answering.

(i) The speaker does not try to comfort the boy because _____. **[1]**

(A) he is angry with the boy
(B) he understands that the boy is learning an important lesson
(C) he does not care about the boy
(D) he wants to buy a new ball

(ii) 'A dime, another ball, is worthless.' Why does the speaker say this? Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
The boy is beginning to learn the meaning of _____ (responsibility / entertainment).

(iv) Which of the following best describes the speaker's attitude towards the boy? **[1]**

(A) mocking **(B)** sympathetic and understanding
(C) indifferent **(D)** impatient

OR

(B) Refer to the last stanza of the poem 'For Anne Gregory' by W. B. Yeats (First Flight), in which an old religious man speaks about who can love a person 'for yourself alone'. Read the lines carefully in your textbook before answering.

(i) According to the old religious man, who can love a person for herself alone? **[1]**

(A) a young man **(B)** God
(C) a poet **(D)** a family friend

(ii) What is the significance of 'yellow hair' in the poem? Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
The poem suggests that human love is often based on _____ (appearance / character).

(iv) Why does Anne say that she can dye her hair brown, black or carrot? **[1]**

8. Answer **any four** of the following five questions in about 40-50 words each. **[4 x 3 = 12]**

(i) Describe the problems the author faced while taking Mijbil with him from Basra to London. *(Mijbil the Otter)*

(ii) How did Rajvir and Pranjol react differently when they reached the tea estate? Give reasons. *(Glimpses of India (Tea from Assam))*

(iii) What help did the pilot receive during the storm? Why does the ending of the story remain mysterious? *(Two Stories about Flying (The Black Aeroplane))*

(iv) What do the trees stand for in the poem? Why are they 'moving out' of the house? *(The Trees)*

(v) What instructions does Amanda keep hearing from the grown-ups around her? How does she escape from them in her imagination? *(Amanda!)*

9. Answer **any two** of the following three questions in about 40-50 words each. **[2 x 3 = 6]**

(i) Why did Horace Danby commit one robbery every year? How did the lady in red turn his plan against him? *(A Question of Trust)*

(ii) How did Herriot 'cure' Tricki Woo? Why did Mrs Pumphrey call it a triumph of surgery? *(A Triumph of Surgery)*

(iii) Why did the Martians decide not to attack the Earth? Answer in about 40 words. *(The Book That Saved the Earth)*

10. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) Lencho's faith in God is firm, yet his reaction to the money he receives shows another side of him. Discuss this with reference to the lesson. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(A Letter to God)*

OR

(B) 'Fog' and 'Dust of Snow' both describe a small moment in nature. Compare how the two poets use imagery to bring out the moment and its effect. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(Fog and Dust of Snow)*

11. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) Hari Singh went to Anil's house as a thief, but Anil's way of dealing with him left a deep mark on him. Explain how, with reference to the story. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(The Thief's Story)*

OR

(B) 'The ability to observe closely and to keep trying is what makes a scientist.' How is this idea shown in the life of Richard Ebright? Answer in about 100–120 words. *(The Making of a Scientist)*

- End of Question Paper -

Career Ka Dost Ask before you decide

Sample Paper 4

CLASS 10 | ENGLISH (LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE)

Board Examination Practice Paper (2026-27 pattern) | Level: Moderate to Hard

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: 3 Hours

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains **11** questions. **All questions are compulsory.**
2. The paper has **three sections**: Section A - Reading Skills (20 marks), Section B - Grammar and Creative Writing Skills (20 marks) and Section C - Literature (40 marks).
3. **Section A:** Q1 and Q2 are passage-based questions (10 marks each). Read the passages carefully and answer the questions that follow.
4. **Section B:** Q3 is a grammar question: attempt **any ten** of the twelve tasks (1 mark each). Q4 is a formal letter and Q5 is an analytical paragraph (5 marks each, about 120 words, with internal choice).
5. **Section C:** Q6 and Q7 are extract-based questions (5 marks each, internal choice). Q8: attempt any four of five questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q9: attempt any two of three questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q10 and Q11: attempt any one of the two given (6 marks each, 100-120 words).
6. In Q6 and Q7, a short passage or the name of the poem with the lines to be read is given. For poems, read the lines named from your textbook before answering.
7. All the details given in the writing tasks are imaginary and have been created for practice only.
8. Marks for each question are shown in square brackets on the right.

SECTION A – READING SKILLS (20 Marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) A generation ago, boredom was a normal part of growing up. A child waiting at a bus stop would look around, count passing cars or simply daydream. Today the same child pulls out a phone within seconds. Our devices have filled every pause in the day, and while that may seem like progress, a growing number of doctors, teachers and psychologists are asking whether we have paid too high a price for it.

(2) The first cost is attention. Apps and games are designed by experts to keep users scrolling; every notification, 'like' and autoplay video is a small prompt to stay longer. Studies in several countries suggest that students who check their phones frequently while studying take more time to finish their work and remember less of it. The mind, it seems, is not built to jump between tasks hundreds of times a day.

(3) Sleep is the second victim. The blue light from screens can delay the release of melatonin, the hormone that tells the body it is time to rest, and the habit of 'one last video' at midnight steals precious hours. Teenagers, who need eight to ten hours of sleep, are among the worst affected, and tired students are more likely to feel irritable and anxious.

(4) Relationships also suffer. Families sit around the same table, yet each member is absorbed in a separate screen. Friends text rather than talk, and the warmth of a face-to-face conversation is replaced by an emoji. Many young people describe feeling lonely even though they are 'connected' to hundreds of people online.

(5) In response, a movement known as 'digital detox' has begun to grow. It asks people to switch off their devices for a fixed period — an evening, a weekend or even a week — and to rediscover the pleasures that do not need a battery: reading, sport, cooking, meeting friends, or simply sitting quietly. Some schools have introduced phone-free hours, and some families have declared the dinner table a 'no-screen zone'.

(6) A detox does not mean rejecting technology. The internet gives us libraries, doctors, classrooms and instant communication, and a wise person does not turn his back on such gifts. The aim is to be the master of the device rather than its servant: to decide when to use it and when to put it down.

(7) Perhaps the best test is a simple question: when did I last sit for ten minutes with nothing but my own thoughts? If the answer is 'I cannot remember', it may be time for a break.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) What is the tone of the writer in the given line? Rationalise your response in about 40 words. **[2]**
"Our devices have filled every pause in the day, and while that may seem like progress, a growing number of doctors, teachers and psychologists are asking whether we have paid too high a price for it." *(Paragraph 1)*

(ii) Which of the following is a correct inference from paragraph 2? **[1]**

(A) Phones help students to remember what they study.
(B) Frequent switching between phone and work makes studying less effective.
(C) Experts design apps to help students concentrate.
(D) Students who use phones finish their work earlier.

(iii) Complete the sentence appropriately. **[1]**
According to paragraph 3, the blue light from screens can delay _____.

(iv) The writer says that 'the warmth of a face-to-face conversation is replaced by an emoji' (paragraph 4) to show that _____. **[1]**

(A) emojis are better than words
(B) online contact often lacks the depth of real conversation
(C) people no longer have friends
(D) conversation has become impossible

(v) Explain any two ways in which excessive screen time affects teenagers, according to the passage. **[2]**

(vi) Select the option closest in meaning to the word 'absorbed' as used in paragraph 4. **[1]**

(A) distracted **(B)** engrossed
(C) tired **(D)** confused

(vii) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. **[1]**
Assertion: A digital detox does not mean rejecting technology.
Reason: The aim is to be the master of the device rather than its servant.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(viii) Which of the following best describes the writer's purpose in the passage? **[1]**

(A) to advertise a new mobile application
(B) to warn readers about the overuse of screens and to encourage a balanced use
(C) to prove that technology has no benefit
(D) to describe the history of the mobile phone

2. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) Sleep experts recommend that teenagers aged 13 to 18 should sleep for 8 to 10 hours every night. A study of 800 students of Classes 9 and 10 in a large city recorded the average number of hours they slept on school days and on holidays. The findings are given in the table below.

Average hours of sleep per night

Group	School days	Holidays
Class 9 boys	6.5	8.0
Class 9 girls	6.8	8.2
Class 10 boys	6.0	7.8
Class 10 girls	6.2	8.0

The students named coaching classes, homework and late-night use of phones as the main reasons for sleeping late. Those who slept for less than seven hours reported more headaches, poor attention in class and a low mood. The researchers advised students to fix a regular bedtime, to keep phones away at least an hour before sleeping and to avoid late evening classes wherever possible.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) According to the experts, how many hours of sleep do teenagers need every night? **[1]**

(A) 5 to 6 hours **(B)** 6 to 7 hours
(C) 8 to 10 hours **(D)** 11 to 12 hours

(ii) According to the table, which group sleeps the least on school days? **[1]**

(iii) How many more hours do Class 9 girls sleep on holidays than on school days? **[1]**

(iv) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. **[1]**

Assertion: Students who sleep for less than seven hours are likely to find it difficult to concentrate in class.
Reason: The study found that such students reported poor attention and headaches.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(v) State whether the following statement is True or False. **[1]**
Students who slept for less than seven hours reported better attention in class.

(vi) Complete the sentence. **[1]**
The researchers advised students to fix a regular _____ and to keep phones away at least an hour before sleeping.

(vii) Which of the following is NOT given as a reason for sleeping late? **[1]**

(A) Coaching classes **(B)** Homework
(C) Late-night use of phones **(D)** Noise from the street

(viii) State one inference that can be drawn from the fact that students sleep longer on holidays than on school days. **[1]**

(ix) In about 40 words, explain what the data in the table suggest about the sleep of teenagers, and what they should do about it. **[2]**

SECTION B – GRAMMAR AND CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (20 Marks)

GRAMMAR

3. Complete **any ten** of the following twelve tasks, as directed. **[10 x 1 = 10]**

(i) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in brackets, for the given portion of a letter. **[1]**
'The company is proud of _____ (win) the national award for the third time.'

(ii) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the given sentence. **[1]**
One of my friends have won a scholarship.

Option	Error	Correction
(A)	one	ones
(B)	of	from
(C)	have	has
(D)	won	win

(iii) The teacher said to Meena, "You have not submitted your assignment yet." **[1]**
Report the teacher's statement.

(iv) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
I _____ him for the past three years, but I have never seen him angry.
(A) know **(B)** am knowing
(C) have known **(D)** knew

(v) Read the dialogue between a manager and an employee. **[1]**
Manager: Did you attend the workshop yesterday ?
Employee: Yes, I found it very useful.
Select the correct option to complete the report.
The manager asked the employee _____. The employee replied that he had found it very useful.
(A) if he attended the workshop yesterday
(B) if he had attended the workshop the previous day
(C) did he attend the workshop the previous day
(D) that he had attended the workshop yesterday

(vi) Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. Use the format given below. **[1]**
I look forward to meet you at the annual function.

Error	Correction

(vii) Report the invigilator's instruction. **[1]**
Invigilator to the candidates: "Do not talk during the examination."
The invigilator told the candidates _____.

(viii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
The principal said that students _____ use the library till 5 p.m. if they wished.
(A) can **(B)** could
(C) must **(D)** shall

(ix) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
Each of the participants _____ given a certificate.

(A) were **(B)** are
(C) was **(D)** have been

(x) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the given sentence. **[1]**
He is much more taller than his brother.

Option	Error	Correction
(A)	is	was
(B)	much	very
(C)	more taller	taller
(D)	than	then

(xi) Read the conversation between Raj and his mother. **[1]**
Raj: I will join the club next month.
Mother: That is a good idea.
Complete the report.
Raj told his mother that _____. His mother said that it was a good idea.

(xii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the line from a school circular. **[1]**
The meeting has been put _____ till next Monday.

(A) off **(B)** away
(C) out **(D)** up

CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for practice purpose.

4. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

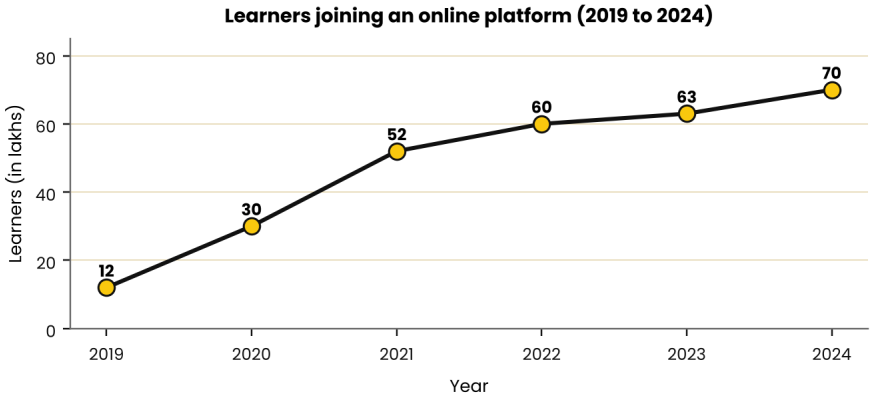
(A) You are Shreya / Shubham, a student of Class 10 of Bright Future School, Civil Lines. The road in front of your school has no speed breakers, and vehicles pass at high speed during school hours. Several students have had narrow escapes. Write a letter, in about 120 words, to the Traffic Commissioner, drawing his attention to the danger and suggesting measures such as speed breakers, a zebra crossing and a traffic warden.

OR

(B) You are Gauri / Gaurav, the head of the student council of Sunrise Public School. Many students in your school feel stressed because of studies and peer pressure. Write a letter to the editor of a local daily, in about 120 words, expressing your views on the need for regular 'wellness periods' in the school timetable and suggesting what such periods can include.

5. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

(A) The line graph below shows the number of learners (in lakhs) who joined an online learning platform from 2019 to 2024. Write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the trend shown. Make comparisons and draw conclusions wherever possible.



OR

(B) Read the following details about social media.
- keeps friends and families connected across distances
- gives young people a platform to share talent and ideas
- spreads false news and encourages comparison and anxiety
- reduces time for study, sleep and outdoor play
- needs responsible use and parental guidance

Analyse the details and write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the benefits and the risks of social media for teenagers.

SECTION C – LITERATURE (40 Marks)

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Read the following passage based on the play 'The Proposal' and answer the questions that follow.

> Lomov, a nervous neighbour, arrives at Chubukov's house dressed in formal clothes. He has come to ask for Natalya's hand in marriage, but before he can explain his purpose properly, a quarrel begins over the ownership of the Oxen Meadows. Each side insists that the land belongs to its own family. Lomov's nerves get worse; he complains of palpitations and a numb leg, and the scene ends in shouting.

(i) Lomov had come to Chubukov's house to _____. **[1]**

(A) borrow money **(B)** propose to Natalya
(C) sell some land **(D)** invite them to a party

(ii) How does the quarrel over the Oxen Meadows bring out the nature of Lomov and Natalya? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
Lomov's complaints of palpitations and a numb leg show that he is _____ (nervous / confident).

(iv) What kind of play is 'The Proposal'? **[1]**

(A) a tragedy **(B)** a farce (a humorous play)
(C) a historical play **(D)** a mystery

OR

(B) Read the following passage based on the story 'Footprints Without Feet' and answer the questions that follow.

> Mrs Hall, the landlady of the inn, was terrified when she saw the furniture in the stranger's room appear to move by itself. She ran out in hysterics, convinced that the room was haunted by spirits and that her strange guest had somehow caused them to enter her furniture. She could not imagine the real explanation: that the man in the room was invisible.

(i) Mrs Hall was convinced that _____. **[1]**

(A) the stranger was a thief **(B)** the room was haunted by spirits
(C) the furniture was old **(D)** her guest was ill

(ii) How does the extract create suspense for the reader? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
Mrs Hall's state at that moment can be described as _____ (terrified / calm).

(iv) What does the phrase 'in hysterics' mean as used in the passage? **[1]**

(A) laughing loudly **(B)** in a state of uncontrolled fear
(C) very tired **(D)** very angry

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Refer to the poem 'Amanda!' by Robin Klein (First Flight), especially the lines beginning 'Don't bite your nails, Amanda!'. Read the lines carefully in your textbook before answering.

(i) The repeated use of the name 'Amanda!' suggests that the tone of the speaker is _____. **[1]**

(A) loving and gentle **(B)** nagging and bossy
(C) humorous **(D)** sad

(ii) How does Amanda escape from the instructions given to her? Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
Amanda's dream of being a mermaid shows her longing for _____ (freedom / fame).

(iv) Why does the poet use exclamation marks in the instructions given to Amanda? **[1]**

OR

(B) Refer to the poem 'Fog' by Carl Sandburg (First Flight), especially the line beginning 'The fog comes on little cat feet'. Read the poem carefully in your textbook before answering.

(i) Identify the figure of speech in the line 'The fog comes on little cat feet'. **[1]**

(A) simile **(B)** metaphor
(C) hyperbole **(D)** onomatopoeia

(ii) How does the poet make the fog seem like a living creature? Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
The poem suggests that the fog stays for a _____ (short / long) time before it moves on.

(iv) Which of the following best describes the mood of the poem? **[1]**

(A) noisy and cheerful **(B)** quiet and mysterious
(C) angry and violent **(D)** sad and hopeless

8. Answer **any four** of the following five questions in about 40-50 words each. **[4 x 3 = 12]**

(i) What did Mandela mean by the 'twin obligations' of a man? Why was it almost impossible for a black South African to fulfil them under apartheid? *(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)*

(ii) How did the young seagull overcome his fear of flying? Who helped him? *(Two Stories about Flying (His First Flight))*

(iii) What unexpected event did Valli face during her bus ride? Why is it significant for the little girl? *(Madam Rides the Bus)*

(iv) What contrast does the poet draw between the tiger's life in the zoo and its life in the jungle? Which words show the tiger's frustration? *(A Tiger in the Zoo)*

(v) How does Custard's character differ from that of the other pets in the house? What humour does the poet create through the descriptions? *(The Tale of Custard the Dragon)*

9. Answer **any two** of the following three questions in about 40-50 words each. **[2 x 3 = 6]**

(i) What was Mr Weiherer's opinion of Richard Ebright, and how did he help him? *(The Making of a Scientist)*

(ii) What was the twist at the end of 'The Necklace'? How did it change Mathilde's view of her ten years of hardship? *(The Necklace)*

(iii) How did the teacher change Bholi's life? Answer in about 40 words. *(Bholi)*

10. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) Do you think the Buddha was right to ask Kisa Gotami to bring a handful of mustard seeds from a house where nobody had died? Give reasons for your answer with reference to the lesson. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(The Sermon at Benares)*

OR

(B) 'A Tiger in the Zoo' and 'The Trees' both speak about confinement and freedom. Compare how the two poets use images to express this idea. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(A Tiger in the Zoo and The Trees)*

11. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) Mrs Pumphrey loved Tricki Woo dearly, yet her love harmed him. Do you think this was true love? Discuss with reference to the story. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(A Triumph of Surgery)*

OR

(B) 'Stereotypes are often misleading.' Justify the statement with reference to Ausable and Fowler's first impression of him in 'The Midnight Visitor'. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(The Midnight Visitor)*

- End of Question Paper -

Sample Paper 5

CLASS 10 | ENGLISH (LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE) Maximum Marks: 80

Board Examination Practice Paper (2026-27 pattern) | Level: Hard Time Allowed: 3 Hours

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains **11** questions. **All questions are compulsory.**
2. The paper has **three sections**: Section A - Reading Skills (20 marks), Section B - Grammar and Creative Writing Skills (20 marks) and Section C - Literature (40 marks).
3. **Section A:** Q1 and Q2 are passage-based questions (10 marks each). Read the passages carefully and answer the questions that follow.
4. **Section B:** Q3 is a grammar question: attempt **any ten** of the twelve tasks (1 mark each). Q4 is a formal letter and Q5 is an analytical paragraph (5 marks each, about 120 words, with internal choice).
5. **Section C:** Q6 and Q7 are extract-based questions (5 marks each, internal choice). Q8: attempt any four of five questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q9: attempt any two of three questions (3 marks each, 40-50 words). Q10 and Q11: attempt any one of the two given (6 marks each, 100-120 words).
6. In Q6 and Q7, a short passage or the name of the poem with the lines to be read is given. For poems, read the lines named from your textbook before answering.
7. All the details given in the writing tasks are imaginary and have been created for practice only.
8. Marks for each question are shown in square brackets on the right.

SECTION A - READING SKILLS (20 Marks)

1. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) We live in a culture that celebrates success loudly and hides failure quietly. The names of toppers are printed in newspapers and shared on social media, while the many attempts that came before their success are rarely mentioned. As a result, young people often grow up believing that talent means getting things right the first time, and that anyone who stumbles must be lacking in ability.

(2) This belief is not only false but harmful. Psychologists who study learning distinguish between two mindsets. A person with a 'fixed' mindset believes that intelligence and talent are inborn and unchangeable; failure, to such a person, is a verdict on who he is. A person with a 'growth' mindset believes that abilities develop through effort; failure, to him, is a piece of information about what to do differently. Research suggests that students with a growth mindset are more willing to take on difficult tasks and recover faster from setbacks.

(3) History offers many examples. Thomas Edison is said to have tried thousands of materials before he found a filament that worked for the electric bulb, and he described these attempts not as failures but as steps that taught him what did not work. Many celebrated writers saw their first manuscripts rejected by several publishers before one finally accepted them.

(4) Failure teaches in ways success cannot. A pass mark tells a student only that he is right, but a wrong answer, if examined honestly, shows him exactly where his understanding broke down. Engineers study collapsed bridges with more attention than standing ones because the broken structure reveals its own weakness. Success may confirm what we know; failure expands it.

(5) None of this means that failure is pleasant, or that we should seek it out. The sting of a poor result is real, and for a teenager surrounded by expectations it can feel unbearable. The point is that the sting need not become a sentence. What matters is the response that follows: whether we blame circumstances, give up, or ask the more difficult question, 'What can I learn from this?'

(6) Parents and teachers have a special part to play. When adults praise only marks and trophies, children learn to avoid risk. When they praise effort, courage and improvement, children learn to attempt what is difficult. A child who is allowed to fail in small matters at home develops the resilience required for larger ones outside.

(7) A life without failure would be a life without ambition, for those who never fail have probably never tried anything worth failing at. The real danger is not that we may fall, but that, afraid of falling, we may never take the first step.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) What is the tone of the writer in the given line? Rationalise your response in about 40 words. **[2]**
"We live in a culture that celebrates success loudly and hides failure quietly."
(Paragraph 1)

(ii) Which of the following best describes a person with a 'fixed' mindset? *(Paragraph 2)* **[1]**

(A) One who believes that abilities grow through effort
(B) One who believes that talent is inborn and failure shows a lack of ability
(C) One who enjoys difficult tasks
(D) One who learns from every mistake

(iii) Complete the sentence appropriately. **[1]**
To a person with a 'growth' mindset, failure is _____. *(Paragraph 2)*

(iv) Explain the comparison between engineers who study collapsed bridges and students who study their wrong answers. Answer in about 40 words. *(Paragraph 4)* **[2]**

(v) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. **[1]**
Assertion: The writer suggests that students should actively look for failure.
Reason: The writer admits that the sting of a poor result is real.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(vi) What does the writer mean by saying that 'the sting need not become a sentence'? *(Paragraph 5)* **[1]**

(A) A poor result should be punished
(B) The pain of a failure need not decide a person's future
(C) Failure is always followed by a sentence
(D) Students should avoid all difficult tasks

(vii) Why do children learn to avoid risk when adults praise only marks and trophies? State one reason. *(Paragraph 6)* **[1]**

(viii) Which of the following statements would the writer most likely agree with? **[1]**

(A) Those who never fail are the most talented.
(B) Failure should be hidden to protect self-confidence.
(C) A person who is afraid of failing may never begin anything worthwhile.
(D) Success is a better teacher than failure.

2. Read the following passage carefully. **[10]**

(1) Trees in a city do more than make it look beautiful. They cool the air, clean it of dust, reduce noise and give shelter to birds. Cities with very little green cover often become 'urban heat islands': areas that are much hotter than the countryside around them, because concrete and asphalt absorb and store more heat than soil and trees do. A study compared the green cover of four cities in 2014 and 2024. The results are given below.

Green cover of four cities (percentage of total area)

City	Population (lakh)	Green cover 2014	Green cover 2024
P	80	14	11
Q	45	9	12
R	120	12	8
S	30	18	19

The researchers noted that City Q had banned the felling of old trees, made tree-planting compulsory for every new building and handed the care of public parks over to local residents' groups. In the other cities, roads, flyovers and buildings were built wherever space was available, and new saplings were rarely looked after.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

(i) Which city recorded the largest fall in green cover between 2014 and 2024? **[1]**

(A) P **(B)** Q
(C) R **(D)** S

(ii) By how many percentage points did the green cover of City Q increase between 2014 and 2024? **[1]**

(iii) What is the difference between the green cover of City S and City R in 2024? **[1]**

(iv) Select the option that is true for the Assertion and Reason given below. **[1]**
Assertion: 'Urban heat islands' are much hotter than the countryside around them.
Reason: Concrete and asphalt absorb and store more heat than soil and trees do.

(A) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(B) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(C) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(D) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

(v) Which of the following can be inferred about City Q from the passage? **[1]**

(A) It has the largest population of the four cities.
(B) Its policies helped to increase its green cover.
(C) It did not construct any new buildings.
(D) Its trees were not cared for.

(vi) Pick a word or phrase from the passage that tells us that new saplings were not looked after in the other cities. **[1]**

(vii) Which of the following statements is supported by the data in the table? **[1]**

(A) The city with the highest population has the highest green cover.
(B) The two cities with the smallest populations did not lose any green cover.
(C) All four cities increased their green cover.
(D) The city with the lowest population lost the most green cover.

(viii) Why does the writer say that trees do 'more than make a city look beautiful'? State one point from the passage. **[1]**

(ix) In about 40 words, evaluate whether larger cities are necessarily the ones that lose more green cover, using the data in the table. **[2]**

SECTION B – GRAMMAR AND CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (20 Marks)

GRAMMAR

3. Complete **any ten** of the following twelve tasks, as directed. **[10 x 1 = 10]**

(i) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in brackets, for the given portion of a letter. **[1]**
'Having _____ (complete) all the formalities, the candidates were allowed to enter the hall.'

(ii) Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. Use the format given below. **[1]**
The principal as well as the teachers were present at the function.

Error	Correction

(iii) The tourist asked the guide, "Can I take photographs inside the museum ?" **[1]**
Report the tourist's question.

(iv) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
No sooner _____ the bell rung than the students rushed out of the classroom.

(A) have **(B)** had
(C) did **(D)** was

(v) Read the dialogue between a doctor and a patient. **[1]**
Doctor: Are you taking your medicines regularly ?
Patient: I took them till last week, but I stopped when I felt better.
Select the correct option to complete the report.
The doctor asked the patient _____. The patient replied that he had taken them till the previous week but had stopped when he had felt better.

(A) if he is taking his medicines regularly
(B) if he was taking his medicines regularly
(C) whether was he taking his medicines regularly
(D) that he was taking his medicines regularly

(vi) Identify the error in the given sentence and supply the correction. Use the format given below. **[1]**
She is one of the best student in our school.

Error	Correction

(vii) Report the request. **[1]**
"Kindly inform me about the date of the examination," Rahul said to the clerk.
Rahul requested the clerk _____.

(viii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
He _____ have reached by now; the train left on time.

(A) can **(B)** should
(C) shall **(D)** will

(ix) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
There were _____ seats left in the hall, so many people had to stand.

(A) a few **(B)** few
(C) little **(D)** a little

(x) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the given sentence. **[1]**
Hardly I had entered the room when the lights went off.

Option	Error	Correction
(A)	Hardly	Scarcely
(B)	I had	had I
(C)	entered	enter
(D)	went off	went out

(xi) Read the conversation between Kabir and Dev. **[1]**
Kabir: I met your brother yesterday.
Dev: Did he tell you about the trip ?
Complete the report.
Kabir told Dev that _____. Dev asked if _____.

(xii) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **[1]**
I wish I _____ more attention in class last year.

(A) paid **(B)** had paid
(C) pay **(D)** would pay

CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for practice purpose.

4. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

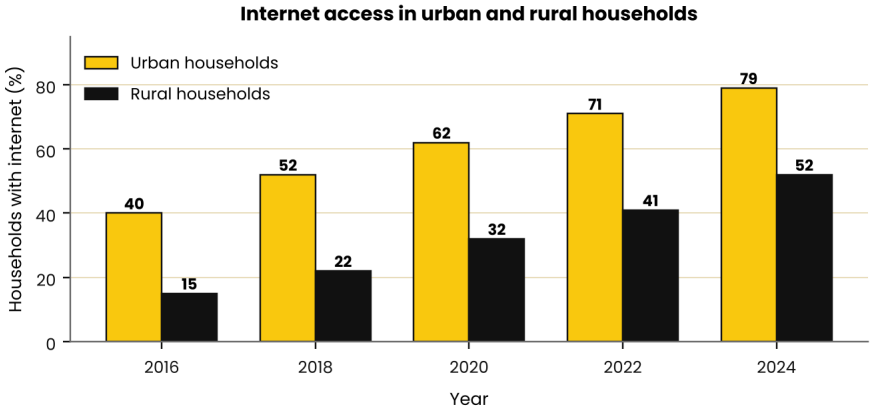
(A) You are Kabir / Kavya, a resident of Rampur village, Block Sonai. Your village is 25 km from the nearest hospital, and people, especially women, children and the elderly, suffer because of the lack of emergency and regular medical care. Write a letter, in about 120 words, to the Chief Medical Officer of your district, urging him to start a mobile health van service for the villages of the area. Give reasons for your request and suggest the facilities the van should provide.

OR

(B) You are Tanya / Tarun, the head girl / head boy of your school. In a recent school survey, six out of ten students admitted that they cannot go for an hour without checking their phones. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily, in about 120 words, expressing your concern about digital addiction among teenagers, giving at least two harmful effects and suggesting steps that schools and families can take.

5. Attempt **any one** from (A) and (B) given below. **[5]**

(A) The bar graph below compares the percentage of urban and rural households with internet access from 2016 to 2024. Write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the information given. Make comparisons, point out the trend and draw a conclusion about the gap between the two areas.



OR

(B) Read the following details about the role of sports in the life of a student.
- improve fitness, posture and immunity
- teach teamwork, discipline and the ability to accept defeat
- reduce stress and improve concentration in studies
- many schools give physical education periods to other subjects
- only one in five schools has a proper playground; trained physical education teachers are few

Analyse the details and write an analytical paragraph, in about 120 words, on the role of sports in a student's life and the steps needed to promote them.

SECTION C – LITERATURE (40 Marks)

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Read the following passage based on the lesson 'Mijbil the Otter' and answer the questions that follow.

> Gavin Maxwell had brought an otter from the marshes of southern Iraq, and he soon discovered that the animal had a strong personality of its own. Mijbil was playful, curious and devoted to his master, but also unpredictable: a journey that began calmly could turn into chaos within minutes. The author, who had at first thought that he was taking home an ordinary pet, slowly realised that he had taken on a responsibility of an unusual kind.

(i) The word 'unpredictable' as used in the passage means _____. **[1]**

(A) easy to guess
(B) likely to change suddenly without warning
(C) very quiet
(D) very lazy

(ii) The author had 'at first thought that he was taking home an ordinary pet'. How does the passage show a change in his understanding? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
Mijbil's behaviour towards his master can be described as _____ (devoted / hostile).

(iv) Which phrase in the passage tells us that Mijbil's behaviour could change quickly? **[1]**

OR

(B) Read the following passage based on the story 'The Midnight Visitor' and answer the questions that follow.

> Fowler, a young writer, visits Ausable, who claims to be a secret agent but looks nothing like one: he is round, soft-looking and cheerful. Fowler secretly wonders whether Ausable's stories are true. The story shows how easily we judge a person by his appearance, and how wrong that judgement can be.

(i) Fowler doubts Ausable because _____. **[1]**

(A) Ausable tells lies often
(B) Ausable does not look like a secret agent
(C) Ausable is a stranger
(D) Ausable is very rude

(ii) 'The story shows how easily we judge a person by his appearance.' How is this idea reflected in Fowler's thoughts? Explain in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
Ausable's appearance is _____ (misleading / accurate) as far as his profession is concerned.

(iv) What does the description 'round, soft-looking and cheerful' suggest about Ausable? **[1]**

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for **any one** of the two given, (A) or (B). **[5]**

(A) Refer to the first stanza of the poem 'The Tale of Custard the Dragon' by Ogden Nash (First Flight), in which Belinda and her pets are introduced. Read the stanza carefully in your textbook before answering.

(i) Select the option that gives the rhyme scheme of the stanza. **[1]**

(A) aabb
(B) abab
(C) abba
(D) abcd

(ii) Explain the humour in the poet's use of the words 'realio, trulio' for the pet dragon. Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
The poet describes the pets by using words that refer to their _____ (colours / habits).

(iv) Which feature of a ballad does the poem use? **[1]**

(A) It tells a story in verse.
(B) It has no rhyme.
(C) It is written only in prose.
(D) It describes a single moment of nature.

OR

(B) Refer to the poem 'The Trees' by Adrienne Rich (First Flight), in which the trees move out of the house towards the forest. Read the poem carefully in your textbook before answering.

(i) In the poem, the trees stand for _____. **[1]**

(A) the beauty of nature
(B) the longing to be free
(C) the fear of the forest
(D) the joy of the seasons

(ii) How does the poet convey the struggle of the trees to move out of the house? Answer in about 40 words. **[2]**

(iii) Fill in the blank with the correct word from the brackets. **[1]**
The movement of the trees suggests _____ (confinement / celebration).

(iv) Which of the following best expresses the central idea of the poem? **[1]**

(A) Nature should be kept indoors.
(B) Living things long to break free and return to where they belong.
(C) Trees are afraid of forests.
(D) Houses protect trees from the wind.

8. Answer **any four** of the following five questions in about 40-50 words each. **[4 x 3 = 12]**

(i) Lencho's second letter shows his unshaken faith in God and, at the same time, a lack of trust in people. Explain this contrast with reference to the lesson. *(A Letter to God)*

(ii) Anne Frank felt lonely even though she had a family and many friends. What does this tell us about the difference between company and true friendship? *(From the Diary of Anne Frank)*

(iii) 'The fog comes on little cat feet.' How does the extended metaphor help the reader to picture the fog? *(Fog)*

(iv) How does the poet use the incident of the lost ball to speak about growing up? *(The Ball Poem)*

(v) How does the narration of 'Madam Rides the Bus' bring out Valli's curiosity and independence? *(Madam Rides the Bus)*

9. Answer **any two** of the following three questions in about 40-50 words each. **[2 x 3 = 6]**

(i) What makes Anil's treatment of Hari Singh special? Support your answer with one incident from the story. *(The Thief's Story)*

(ii) In what ways was the teacher's attitude towards Bholi different from that of her parents? *(Bholi)*

(iii) How does the playwright use the Martians' ignorance to create humour and to suggest the importance of books? *(The Book That Saved the Earth)*

10. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) Mandela's speech moves between the memory of a painful past and the promise of a new future. Evaluate how these two strands together give the lesson its power. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)*

OR

(B) 'Dust of Snow' and 'Fire and Ice' are both by Robert Frost, yet they leave the reader with very different feelings. Compare the two poems with reference to theme and tone. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(Dust of Snow and Fire and Ice)*

11. Answer **any one** of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. **[6]**

(A) Mathilde's pride cost her ten years of her life. Was she a victim of circumstances or of her own vanity? Evaluate the statement with reference to 'The Necklace'. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(The Necklace)*

OR

(B) Griffin's genius made him invisible, but his own character made him an outcast. Evaluate whether Griffin deserves our sympathy, with reference to the lesson. Answer in about 100–120 words. *(Footprints Without Feet)*

- End of Question Paper -

All the Best!

You have done the hard work. Now go and show it on the paper.

Exam-day reminders

1	Use the first 15 minutes to read the whole paper and plan your time.
2	Spend about 40 minutes on Section A, 50 minutes on Section B and 80 minutes on Section C, and keep 10 minutes for revision.
3	In the reading section, find the answer in the passage first and then write it in your own words. Respect the word limits.
4	In grammar, read the sentence twice and check tense, subject-verb agreement and the reporting verb before you mark an answer.
5	In the letter, use the correct format: sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, body in short paragraphs, closing. In the analytical paragraph, compare, give figures and end with a conclusion.
6	For literature answers, name the lesson, give one point per mark and support it with a line or incident from the text.
7	Solve the 5 papers one by one, from Paper 1 (easy) to Paper 5 (hard), in exam conditions and revise from the textbook after each.

Career Ka Dost
Ask before you decide